

other town to those prevailing in my own district.

Finally, it must be remembered that the conditions prevailing in one district may not be the same as those in another. Industries capable of being carried on quite comfortably in Barking might be a nuisance or cause great pecuniary loss in Kensington, so each place must be studied by itself. But it is to be hoped that by discreet and careful manipulation of their powers there will eventually result a wise and skilful town planning, which will enable the manufacturer to do his work in the easiest and most profitable way, and the private resident to enjoy in his own home that freedom from noise and smell which is necessary for our health in these days of strenuous exertion.

SHELTERS FOR CONSUMPTIVES AT BERMONDSEY. The Local Government Board have informed the Bermondsey Borough Council that the Council is competent to provide (under Section 75, Public Health (London) Act, 1891) portable shelters, with the necessary furniture and bedding, as temporary places for the reception of consumptive inhabitants of the borough.

The medical officer of health states that the shelters will cost about £4 10s. each, and he hopes to begin with about four. They are collapsible, on wheels, a very simple contrivance, like a summer-house, with three sides, a floor, and slanting roof, and a piece of canvas to be hung along the open front in very wet weather.

They will be erected in the back-yards (Bermondsey has few gardens) of patients returning from the Maitland Sanatorium, where the Council at 30s. weekly each, rent three beds for poor Bermondsey consumptives. These convalescents, understanding the fresh air treatment, will know how to make the best use of the shelters.

FAILING TO NOTIFY A BIRTH.—At the York Police Court, on April 23rd, Elizabeth Leadby, Long Close Lane, Walmgate, was summoned for failing to notify the medical officer of health of the birth of a child within six hours of its birth or give notice in writing within 36 hours, she being the person in attendance upon the mother.

The Town Clerk (Mr. H. Craven) said that the summons was issued under the Notification of Births Act, 1907, and was the first case taken by the Health Committee.

Defendant pleaded ignorance. She was fined 5s. and costs.

ARE UNVACCINATED PERSONS A DANGER TO THE COMMUNITY?

By C. KILLICK MILLARD, M.D., D.Sc.,
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THE recent outbreak of small-pox in the East End of London calls attention to an aspect of the Vaccination Question which, in spite of all that has been written on this vexed controversy, has hitherto received but little attention.

It has always been an axiom with the advocates of compulsory vaccination, and has been put forward as one of the principal grounds on which compulsion can be justified, that *an unvaccinated person is a danger to the community*. He is supposed to act as a sort of *nidus* for the disease to which infection will be attracted, and in which it will germinate, burst into flame, and spread the disease abroad. Certainly, this line of argument was emphasised by the early advocates of compulsion, and it has never hitherto been openly repudiated by provaccinists. On the strength of it innumerable persons have been penalised by fines and imprisonment, and a system closely akin to persecution was inaugurated.

Now the object of this letter is to definitely challenge this contention that in this country, and at the present day, unvaccinated persons constitute any special danger to the community in which they dwell. I suggest that it is open to question whether, under modern conditions, they are as great a danger as persons who, in the eye of the law, are "vaccinated," but whose vaccination, through the lapse of time, has ceased to protect.

Lest there should be any misapprehension as to where I stand, let me say at once that I write as an absolute and outspoken believer in the power of vaccination to confer, upon the individual, absolute protection against smallpox for a limited period—usually a few years, and in its power to mitigate the severity of an attack after its power to prevent an attack has worn out.

In order to place my belief in this protective power of vaccination beyond possibility of doubt, some years ago, during an outbreak of smallpox in Leicester, I took my wife and two children (the youngest a babe in arms), all recently vaccinated, to the Leicester Smallpox Hospital and had them photographed sitting by the bedside of a bad confluent case of smallpox. Few medical men, I imagine, have testified to their faith in vaccination in such a crucial manner. But whilst this undoubted power of vaccination to protect the individual absolutely for a limited period is rightly regarded